

ISMAILA IDRIS SINAN, PhD

Cybersecurity & AI Researcher | Digital Transformation | Data & Digital Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity and AI researcher with a PhD in Cybersecurity and extensive professional experience spanning digital infrastructure, cloud systems, secure data architectures, artificial intelligence, and digital learning. Proven track record in supporting digital transformation initiatives, coordinating AI programmes, conducting applied research, developing grant proposals, and building technical capacity. Possesses international research and professional exposure across France, China, Benin, Morocco, and Senegal, with a core focus on cybersecurity, digital resilience, data governance, and inclusive digital development. A published scholar dedicated to deploying digital and AI innovations to fortify resilience, human capital, and sustainable growth.

CORE EXPERTISE

- **Digital Transformation & Infrastructure:** Cloud systems, enterprise ICT, data centres, and digital learning platforms.
- **Data, AI & Responsible AI:** AI/ML applications, data-centric architectures, AI governance, privacy, and responsible AI frameworks.
- **Cybersecurity & Data Governance:** Cybersecurity architecture, information security, risk management, and data protection.
- **Research & Policy Analysis:** Applied research, quantitative and qualitative analysis, policy-oriented studies, and grant proposal writing.
- **Programme & Stakeholder Management:** AI programme coordination, multidisciplinary collaboration, and institutional capacity building.
- **Technical Training:** Cisco Networking Academy instruction, cybersecurity instruction, and ICT education.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

NATIONAL OPEN UNIVERSITY OF NIGERIA (NOUN)

- **Research Fellow II** *(August 2025 – Present)*
- **Assistant Programme Coordinator, Artificial Intelligence** *(January 2025 – Present)*
- **Lab Technologist, AI Laboratory** *(July 2024 – December 2024)*
- **Network Administrator** *(January 2023 – June 2024)*
- Conduct advanced research at the intersection of cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, data governance, and digital learning.

- Formulate research concepts, grant proposals, and funding applications targeting emerging digital and cybersecurity challenges.
- Coordinate operational and academic activities within the Artificial Intelligence programme, mentoring students on applied AI projects.
- Facilitate the integration of cutting-edge AI-driven tools and technologies into academic curricula and institutional research frameworks.
- Supervised students in architecting AI models and practical technical solutions within the dedicated AI Laboratory.
- Spearheaded the migration of university systems to robust cloud infrastructure, achieving an approximate 30% improvement in system uptime.
- Directed data-centre operations and ICT governance for institutional digital services, prioritizing security, availability, resilience, and business continuity.
- Partnered with multidisciplinary teams to fortify the security and reliability of enterprise digital learning platforms.

INRIA, FRANCE — PIRAT RESEARCH TEAM

- **Research Intern** (*May 2023 – October 2023*)
- Investigated AI-driven cybersecurity methodologies aimed at ensuring resilient digital infrastructure.
- Collaborated closely with international researchers within a multidisciplinary, high-impact environment.
- Contributed to core research deliverables focusing on advanced cybersecurity frameworks and digital resilience.

DIGITAL FOOTPRINTS

- **Cybersecurity / Digital Forensics Intern** (*June 2022 – November 2022*)
- Executed comprehensive cybersecurity assessments and assisted with digital-forensics investigations.
- Analyzed digital evidence logs and evaluated associated enterprise cybersecurity risks.
- Authored technical documentation and research reports for specialized cybersecurity engagements.

SELECTED LEADERSHIP & IMPACT

- **Cisco Networking Academy Instructor:** Trained, mentored, and certified 200+ students in advanced networking, cybersecurity principles, and foundational IT skills, driving local digital capacity building.
- **Hackathon Team Leader — Gaston Berger University, Senegal (2021):** Commanded an international team of MSc students through an intensive technology innovation challenge, securing 3rd place and demonstrating agile leadership and collaborative problem-solving.

EDUCATION

- **Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in Cybersecurity** — National Open University of Nigeria (*2021 – 2024*)
- **Master of Science (MSc) in Computer Science (Data Mining)** — Bayero University, Kano (*2014 – 2018*)
- **Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Computer Science** — Bayero University, Kano (*2008 – 2013*)

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco CyberOps Associate — 2023
- Cisco CCNA 1 — 2021
- IBM AI Analyst — 2020
- Cisco IT Essentials — 2019
- Cisco Introduction to IoT — 2019

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Sinan, I.I. et al. (2024). "Enhancing Security and Privacy in Educational Environments." JIPD.
- Sinan, I.I. et al. (2024). "Data Architectures and Cyberattacks in West African Institutions." JIPD.
- Sinan, I.I. et al. (2022). "A Comparison of Data-Driven and Data-Centric Architectures using E-Learning Solutions." ICADEIS, Bandung, Indonesia.
- Sinan, I.I. et al. (2022). "E-Learning Digitalization Evolution." ECOWAS iSTEAMS Conference, Ghana.
- Sinan, I.I. et al. (2019). "Improved C4.5 Model Classification Algorithm." JJCIT.

INTERNATIONAL EXPOSURE & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- **UCASS Seminar, Beijing, China (2025):** Focused on national governance and digital transformation frameworks.
- **French Embassy Scholarship / INRIA Programme (2024)**
- **Advanced Ubuntu Linux Server Training, Morocco (2024)**
- **Digital Forensics Bootcamp, Nigeria (2024)**
- **DSTN Student Exchange Programme, University of Abomey, Benin (2022)**
- **High-Performance Computing Workshops, Nigeria (2021 & 2023)**

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Fluent | **Hausa:** Fluent